SSC MTS 2021 Paper-I question paper with answers

15 July 2022 · Shift 3

68 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +1 for a right answer, –0.25 for a wrong one

The other 32 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20221017140324/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/Writeup_FinalAnswerKeyMTS2021_17102022.pdf

General English 25 questions

Q.1

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Flared

(A) Darkened
(B) Radiated
(C) Flamed
(D) Glared

Q.2

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Impolite

(A) Courteous
(B) Superior
(C) Uncivil
(D) Blunt

Q.3

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. Of or relating to the moon

(A) Solar
(B) Platonic
(C) Fatal
(D) Lunar

Q.4

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'. A clinical thermometer “consists of a” long, narrow, uniform glass tube.

(A) consisting of a
(B) No improvement required
(C) consist of a
(D) consisted in a

Q.5

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Move the goalposts

(A) Unfairly alter the conditions or rules of a procedure during its course
(B) To do your research and understand clearly what your goals are
(C) To put a lot of effort into something
(D) To move the goalpost after an attempt has been made to score a goal

Q.6

Parts of the given sentence have been given as options. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don’t find any error, mark ‘No error’ as your answer. I have watched a lot of students excel in online courses, taking fully advantage of the convenience.

(A) excel in online courses, taking fully
(B) advantage of the convenience
(C) I have watched a lot of students
(D) No error

Q.7

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the given sentence. Stop “crying for the moon” and start coming up with some sensible demands.

(A) To understand the hidden meaning
(B) To make money unfairly
(C) To make an impractical or unreasonable request
(D) To praise one’s efforts

Q.8

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Artful

(A) Prudent
(B) Benign
(C) Ignorant
(D) Crafty

Q.9

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don’t find any error, mark ‘No error’ as your answer. Age doesn’t seeming to diminish our capacity to speak, write and learn new things.

(A) Age doesn’t seeming to
(B) No error
(C) write and learn new things
(D) diminish our capacity to speak

Q.10

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Fasting _____ some festivals increases the consumption of fruits.

(A) during
(B) while
(C) when
(D) about

Q.11

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Da Vinci's paintings reveal an obsessive fascination with _____ rituals, like those of the Freemasons.

(A) Magnetic
(B) Pathetic
(C) Static
(D) Enigmatic

Q.12

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don’t find any error, mark ‘No error’ as your answer. Sometimes we interact to people who are closed-minded and not willing to listen.

(A) to people who are closed-minded
(B) and not willing to listen
(C) Sometimes we interact
(D) No error

Q.13

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. A system of government by the wealthy class

(A) Theocracy
(B) Plutocracy
(C) Autocracy
(D) Democracy

Q.14

Select the option that corrects the misspelt words in the given sentence. My freind is blessed with perfect gines.

(A) My friend is blessed with perfct gines.
(B) My freind is bllessed with perfct gines.
(C) My freind is blesed with perfect genes.
(D) My friend is blessed with perfect genes.

Q.15

Select the correctly spelt word.

(A) Telivision
(B) Televison
(C) Televisoin
(D) Television

Q.16

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'. Antibiotics "are one off the" most commonly prescribed drugs in the world.

(A) No improvement required
(B) are one of a
(C) are one of the
(D) is one of the

Q.17

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. She refused to back _____, so she was fired from the company.

(A) down
(B) over
(C) upon
(D) into

Q.18

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'. You "is not allowed" to sit here without permission.

(A) has not allowed
(B) are not allowed
(C) is no allowing
(D) No improvement required

Q.19

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Tenderness

(A) Ruthlessness
(B) Severity
(C) Kindness
(D) Spitefulness

Q.20

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. The Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change (IPCC) _____ the idea of 'tipping points' two decades ago.

(A) introduced
(B) shortened
(C) wounded
(D) withdrawn

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Delhi's meteorology (1) _____ the quantity of chaff burnt play a greater role in (2) _____ air quality than the time chosen by farmers in Punjab to start crop burning, a study argues. Crop burning, a traditional practice in Punjab and Haryana of (3) _____ fields off rice chaff to prepare for winter sowing, begins around October and (4) _____ in November, coinciding with the (5) _____ of southwest monsoon.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) among
(B) and
(C) yet
(D) but

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Delhi's meteorology (1) _____ the quantity of chaff burnt play a greater role in (2) _____ air quality than the time chosen by farmers in Punjab to start crop burning, a study argues. Crop burning, a traditional practice in Punjab and Haryana of (3) _____ fields off rice chaff to prepare for winter sowing, begins around October and (4) _____ in November, coinciding with the (5) _____ of southwest monsoon.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) worsening
(B) worsens
(C) worsen
(D) worse

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Delhi's meteorology (1) _____ the quantity of chaff burnt play a greater role in (2) _____ air quality than the time chosen by farmers in Punjab to start crop burning, a study argues. Crop burning, a traditional practice in Punjab and Haryana of (3) _____ fields off rice chaff to prepare for winter sowing, begins around October and (4) _____ in November, coinciding with the (5) _____ of southwest monsoon.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) racing
(B) raising
(C) rising
(D) razing

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Delhi's meteorology (1) _____ the quantity of chaff burnt play a greater role in (2) _____ air quality than the time chosen by farmers in Punjab to start crop burning, a study argues. Crop burning, a traditional practice in Punjab and Haryana of (3) _____ fields off rice chaff to prepare for winter sowing, begins around October and (4) _____ in November, coinciding with the (5) _____ of southwest monsoon.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) leaks
(B) creaks
(C) falls
(D) peaks

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Delhi's meteorology (1) _____ the quantity of chaff burnt play a greater role in (2) _____ air quality than the time chosen by farmers in Punjab to start crop burning, a study argues. Crop burning, a traditional practice in Punjab and Haryana of (3) _____ fields off rice chaff to prepare for winter sowing, begins around October and (4) _____ in November, coinciding with the (5) _____ of southwest monsoon.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) availing
(B) managing
(C) running
(D) withdrawal

General Intelligence and Reasoning 19 questions

Q.1

In a certain code language, 'O' is coded as '15' and 'ADD' is coded as '9'. How will 'PURE' be coded in that language?

(A) 60
(B) 58
(C) 57
(D) 59

Q.2

P, Q, R, S, T, U and V are seven friends who scored different marks in a test. Scores of only two people lies between the scores of S and P with score of P greater than S. . R scored the highest marks. T scored more than Q. U and V scored second least and the least marks respectively. Who scored the fourth highest marks?

(A) P
(B) Q
(C) R
(D) S

Q.3

Select the option that is related to the third number in the same way as the second number is related to the first number. 2041 : 346 :: 5310 : ?

(A) 664
(B) 732
(C) 516
(D) 956

Q.4

Select the letter-cluster from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. WUE, XXG, YAI, ?

(A) ZDK
(B) ZOK
(C) ZBH
(D) ZAJ

Q.5

Select the number that will come next in the following series. 2, 4, 7, 11, 16, ?

(A) 22
(B) 21
(C) 20
(D) 23

Q.6

Select the option in which the words share the same relationship as that shared by the given pair of words. Money : Wallet

(A) Books : Cardboard
(B) Bag : Box
(C) Safety: Locker
(D) Letter : Envelop

Q.7

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: All bottles are jugs. All jugs are cups. Conclusions: I. All bottles are cups. II. All cups are bottles.

(A) Neither conclusion I nor II follows
(B) Both conclusions I and II follow
(C) Only conclusion I follows
(D) Only conclusion II follows

Q.8

Which of the number (not digits) should be interchanged in the given equation to make it mathematically correct? $12 \div 3 - 2 + 5 \times 4 = 23$

(A) 3 and 4
(B) 3 and 2
(C) 3 and 5
(D) 4 and 5

Q.9

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: Some belts are leathers. All leathers are skins. Some skins are white. Conclusions: I. Some belts are skins. II. Some belts are white.

(A) Either conclusion I or II follows
(B) Neither conclusion I nor II follows
(C) Only conclusion II follows
(D) Only conclusion I follows

Q.11

Select the option that is related to the fifth number in the same way as the second number is related to the first number and the fourth number is related to the third number. (NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding /deleting /multiplying etc. to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed) 2 : 16 :: 3 : 81 :: 6 : ?

(A) 1326
(B) 1296
(C) 1666
(D) 1524

Q.12

In a certain code language, 'ABKN' is coded as '84', and 'PNCL' is coded as '135'. How will 'HONT' be coded in that language?

(A) 181
(B) 171
(C) 169
(D) 147

Q.15

Six girls are sitting in two straight rows, facing the North. Their names are Farah, Urvashi, Yukti, Kritika, Neha and Mudita. Farah and Mudita are sitting diagonally opposite. Urvashi is in the top row and to the immediate right of Farah. Kritika is second to the left of Mudita while Yukti and Kritika are not in the same row. Who is sitting diagonally opposite to Yukti?

(A) Urvashi
(B) Kritika
(C) Mudita
(D) Neha

Q.17

Select the option that is related to the fifth term in the same way as the second term is related to the first term and the fourth term is related to the third term. SACRIFY : ARFYICS :: NUMERAL : UEALRMN :: SHALLOW : ?

(A) HLLWOAS
(B) HLOWLAS
(C) HLOLAWS
(D) HLWLASO

Q.18

What will come in the place of '?' in the following equation, if '×' and '–' are interchanged and also '+' and '÷' are interchanged? 60 + 2 – 3 × 4 ÷ 2 = ?

(A) 90
(B) 88
(C) 45
(D) 27

Q.19

Six friends are sitting around a circular table facing the centre. Dilip is immediate neighbour of both Priya and Payal. Priti is immediate neighbour of both Mukesh and Leela. Payal is sitting to the immediate right of Mukesh. Who is sitting to the immediate right of Priya?

(A) Dilip
(B) Payal
(C) Leela
(D) Mukesh

Q.20

In a certain code language, '456' is written as 'sky is high', '678' is written as 'sky has dark', and '147' is written as 'star is dark'. What is the code for the word 'star' in that language?

(A) 4
(B) 1
(C) 7
(D) 5

Q.21

Select the option that is related to the fifth letter-cluster in the same way as the second letter-cluster is related to the first letter-cluster and the fourth letter-cluster is related to the third letter-cluster. CAM : EES :: OAT : QEZ :: TOI : ?

(A) USO
(B) VTO
(C) VSO
(D) VSP

Q.23

If ORDER = $*5@* and MATTER = 2&33@*, then ROAD = ?

(A) $*5&
(B) $$5&
(C) *$&5
(D) #*5$

Q.25

Select the option that will replace the question mark (?) in the given series. 78, 89, 82, 87, 84, ?

(A) 88
(B) 86
(C) 80
(D) 78

General Awareness 24 questions

Q.1

Who will be India's next Foreign Secretary as announced in April 2022?

(A) Harsh Vardhan Shringla
(B) Dr S Jaishankar
(C) Sushma Swaraj
(D) Vinay Mohan Kwatra

Q.2

Which of the following is the least literate state in India according to Census 2021?

(A) Gujarat
(B) Bihar
(C) Assam
(D) Odisha

Q.3

'Gangaur' is an Indian festival majorly celebrated in _____.

(A) Rajasthan
(B) Himachal Pradesh
(C) Tripura
(D) Arunachal Pradesh

Q.4

Which of the following is categorised under slow mass movement in geomorphic processes?

(A) Creep
(B) Earthflow
(C) Mudflow
(D) Landslide

Q.5

Prarthana Samaj or 'Prayer Society', a religious and social reform, was found in 1863 at _____.

(A) Pune
(B) Delhi
(C) Surat
(D) Bombay (now Mumbai)

Q.6

National Sports Day of India is celebrated on _____.

(A) 15 August
(B) 26 January
(C) 30 January
(D) 29 August

Q.7

Who among the following was a Shaka ruler in India (130-150 AD)?

(A) Ashoka
(B) Rudradaman
(C) Menander
(D) Bindusara

Q.8

Which part of the Indian Constitution has been drawn from the British Constitution?

(A) Fundamental Rights and the Directive Principles of State Policy
(B) Principle of Cabinet Government and the relations between the executive and the legislature
(C) Appointment of state governors by the centre
(D) Federation with a strong centre

Q.9

According to the Census 2011, which of the following is the third-lowest state in terms of literacy rate?

(A) Bihar
(B) Madhya Pradesh
(C) Rajasthan
(D) Sikkim

Q.10

_____ is a disease which is transmitted by the Aedes mosquito which lays eggs in water-logged places and multiply over time.

(A) Diarrhoea
(B) Elephantiasis
(C) Dengue
(D) Malaria

Q.11

Which type of forest receives more than 200 cm of annual rainfall?

(A) Temperate mixed forests
(B) Taiga
(C) Tropical evergreen rain forests
(D) Tundra forests

Q.12

What was the shape of the Great Bath of Mohenjo Daro?

(A) Rectangular
(B) Square
(C) Elliptical
(D) Circular

Q.13

BR Ambedkar wrote a 20-page autobiography about his experiences with untouchability which is known as _____.

(A) All from Memory
(B) My Experiments with Silence
(C) Waiting for a Visa
(D) Courage and Conviction

Q.14

Kelucharan Mohapatra is associated with _____ dance form of India.

(A) Kathak
(B) Hiphop
(C) Odissi
(D) Salsa

Q.15
Who was the founder of the reform movement, Arya Samaj?

(A) Swami Dayananda Saraswati
(B) Raja Ram Mohan Roy
(C) Anand Mohan Bose
(D) MG Ranade

Q.16
What does F stand for in the FRBM Act, 2003 of the Indian economy?

(A) Financial
(B) Fiscal
(C) Functional
(D) Freedom

Q.17
Which of the following laws is applicable to the force of attraction or repulsion between two point charges?

(A) Kirchhoff's Law
(B) Newton's Law of Universal Gravitation
(C) Coulomb's Law
(D) Newton's Laws of Motion

Q.18
Which of the following is an example of Phylum Annelida of Animal Kingdom?

(A) Honey bee
(B) Earthworm
(C) Squid
(D) Kangaroo

Q.19
Which state government launched the Udaan Project in collaboration with IPE Global which attempts to keep girls in schools through their enrolment at the secondary level while ensuring that the eligible ones among them get their scholarships?

(A) Maharashtra
(B) Assam
(C) Rajasthan
(D) Punjab

Q.20
The World Health Organisation defines adolescents as individuals in the age-group of _____.

(A) 10 to 19 years
(B) 8 to 15 years
(C) 12 to 16 years
(D) 6 to 14 years

Q.21
Pandit Shiv Kumar Sharma is associated with _____ musical instrument.

(A) piano
(B) sarod
(C) harmonica
(D) santoor

Q.22
Who is the first Law officer of India?

(A) President
(B) Governor
(C) Prime Minister
(D) Attorney-General

Q.23
Who among the following rulers was chronicled by Minhaj-i Siraj?

(A) Akbar
(B) Razia Sultan
(C) Babur
(D) Ghiyasuddin Tughluq

Q.24
For which dance form did Aparna Satheesan win the Prestigious National Nritya Shiromani Award 2022?

(A) Kuchipudi
(B) Mohiniyattam
(C) Kathakali
(D) Odissi

Answer key

General English

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(A)**
Q.7 **(C)**	Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(A)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.12 **(A)**
Q.13 **(B)**	Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(D)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(B)**
Q.19 **(C)**	Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(B)**	Q.22 **(A)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(D)**
Q.25 **(D)**					

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(D)**
Q.7 **(C)**	Q.8 **(B)**	Q.9 **(D)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(B)**	Q.15 **(B)**
Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(B)**	Q.19 **(C)**	Q.20 **(B)**	Q.21 **(C)**	Q.23 **(C)**
Q.25 **(B)**					

General Awareness

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(D)**	Q.6 **(D)**
Q.7 **(B)**	Q.8 **(B)**	Q.9 **(C)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.12 **(A)**
Q.13 **(C)**	Q.14 **(C)**	Q.15 **(A)**	Q.16 **(B)**	Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(B)**
Q.19 **(C)**	Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.24 **(A)**

Explanations

General English

Q.1 · Answer (A) Darkened

'Flared' means blazed up brightly, so its opposite is 'darkened'. 'Radiated', 'flamed' and 'glared' are close to it in meaning.

Q.2 · Answer (A) Courteous

'Impolite' means rude; its opposite is 'courteous'. 'Uncivil' and 'blunt' are close to it in meaning.

Q.3 · Answer (D) Lunar

'Lunar' means of or relating to the moon. 'Solar' relates to the sun, 'platonic' describes a friendship without romance, and 'fatal' means causing death.

Q.4 · Answer (B) No improvement required

A general fact takes the simple present, and the singular subject 'a clinical thermometer' takes 'consists': the sentence is already correct.

Q.5 · Answer (A) Unfairly alter the conditions or rules of a procedure during its course

To 'move the goalposts' is to change the rules or conditions of something unfairly while it is under way.

Q.6 · Answer (A) excel in online courses, taking fully

'Advantage' is a noun, so it needs the adjective 'full', not the adverb 'fully': 'taking full advantage of the convenience'.

Q.7 · Answer (C) To make an impractical or unreasonable request

To 'cry for the moon' is to ask for something impossible or unreasonable.

Q.8 · Answer (D) Crafty

'Artful' means clever in a cunning way: 'crafty'. 'Prudent' means careful, 'benign' kindly and 'ignorant' lacking knowledge.

Q.9 · Answer (A) Age doesn’t seeming to

After the auxiliary 'doesn't' the verb takes its base form: 'Age doesn't seem to diminish our capacity...'.

Q.10 · Answer (A) during

'During' is the preposition for something that happens in the course of an event: 'fasting during some festivals'. 'While' and 'when' are conjunctions that need a clause after them.

Q.11 · Answer (D) Enigmatic

'Enigmatic' means mysterious, which suits secretive rituals like those of the Freemasons. 'Magnetic', 'pathetic' and 'static' do not fit the sense.

Q.12 · Answer (A) to people who are closed-minded

'Interact' takes 'with', not 'to': 'Sometimes we interact with people who are closed-minded'.

Q.13 · Answer (B) Plutocracy

Plutocracy is government by the wealthy. Theocracy is rule by religious leaders, autocracy by one person with absolute power, and democracy by the people.

Q.14 · Answer (D) My friend is blessed with perfect genes.

The correct spellings are 'friend' and 'genes' (the units of heredity); only the last option has both, with 'blessed' and 'perfect' also spelt right.

Q.15 · Answer (D) Television

The correct spelling is 'television'.

Q.16 · Answer (C) are one of the

'Off' should be 'of': 'one of the' goes before a superlative and a plural noun, and the plural subject 'antibiotics' keeps 'are'.

Q.17 · Answer (A) down
To 'back down' is to give up a demand or position: she would not give way, so she was fired.

Q.18 · Answer (B) are not allowed
'You' always takes the plural verb form 'are': 'You are not allowed to sit here without permission.'

Q.19 · Answer (C) Kindness
'Tenderness' is gentleness and care: 'kindness'. 'Ruthlessness', 'severity' and 'spitefulness' are nearly its opposite.

Q.20 · Answer (A) introduced
An idea is 'introduced' when it is first put forward, and the simple past suits 'two decades ago'. 'Withdrawn' would need 'had', and 'shortened' and 'wounded' do not fit an idea.

Q.21 · Answer (B) and
'And' joins the two subjects, Delhi's meteorology and the quantity of chaff burnt, which is why the verb is the plural 'play'.

Q.22 · Answer (A) worsening
A preposition ('in') is followed by the '-ing' form: a role 'in worsening air quality'.

Q.23 · Answer (D) razing
SSC's key gives 'razing'. To raze is to level something or scrape it bare, as burning clears the fields of rice chaff; 'racing', 'raising' and 'rising' make no sense here.

Q.24 · Answer (D) peaks
Crop burning begins in October and 'peaks', reaches its highest point, in November.

Q.25 · Answer (D) withdrawal
The burning season coincides with the 'withdrawal', or retreat, of the southwest monsoon in October and November; the blank after 'the' needs a noun.

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 · Answer (A) 60
Each word is coded as the sum of its letters' places in the alphabet: O = 15 and ADD = 1 + 4 + 4 = 9. So PURE = 16 + 21 + 18 + 5 = 60.

Q.2 · Answer (B) Q
R is first, U sixth and V seventh. With exactly two people between S and P, and P higher, P must be second and S fifth. T and Q take third and fourth, with T above Q, so Q is fourth.

Q.3 · Answer (B) 732
The second number is the cube of the first number's digit sum, plus 3: 2 + 0 + 4 + 1 = 7 and $7^3 + 3 = 346$. So 5 + 3 + 1 + 0 = 9 and $9^3 + 3 = 732$.

Q.4 · Answer (A) ZDK
The first letters move +1 (W, X, Y, Z), the second +3 (U, X, A, D) and the third +2 (E, G, I, K): ZDK.

Q.5 · Answer (A) 22
The differences are 2, 3, 4, 5, rising by 1, so the next term is 16 + 6 = 22.

Q.6 · Answer (D) Letter : Envelop
Money is kept in a wallet, as a letter is kept in an envelope (printed 'Envelop'). A locker keeps things safe, but safety is not kept in it.

Q.7 · Answer (C) Only conclusion I follows
All bottles are jugs and all jugs are cups, so all bottles are cups (I follows). There may be cups that are not bottles, so II does not follow.

Q.8 · Answer (B) 3 and 2
Interchanging 3 and 2: 12 ÷ 2 – 3 + 5 × 4 = 6 – 3 + 20 = 23.

Q.9 · Answer (D) Only conclusion I follows
Some belts are leathers and all leathers are skins, so some belts are skins (I follows). The white skins need not include any belts, so II does not follow.

Q.11 · Answer (B) 1296
Each second number is the first raised to the fourth power: $2^4 = 16$ and $3^4 = 81$. So $6^4 = 1296$.

Q.12 · Answer (B) 171
Each code is 3 times the sum of the letters' places in the alphabet: ABKN → (1 + 2 + 11 + 14) × 3 = 84 and PNCL → (16 + 14 + 3 + 12) × 3 = 135. So HONT → (8 + 15 + 14 + 20) × 3 = 57 × 3 = 171.

Q.15 · Answer (B) Kritika
Urvashi and Farah are in the top row, so Mudita, diagonally opposite Farah, is in the bottom row with Kritika (second to her left), and Yukti is in the top row. In rows of three, Kritika and Mudita take the bottom row's left and right ends, Farah (diagonal to Mudita) the top left, Urvashi the top middle and Yukti the top right, diagonally opposite Kritika.

Q.17 · Answer (B) HLOWLAS
The letters in places 2, 4 and 6 come first, then those in places 7, 5, 3 and 1: SACRIFY → A R F, Y I C S. So SHALLOW → H L O, W L A S: HLOWLAS.

Q.18 · Answer (B) 88
After the interchanges: 60 ÷ 2 × 3 – 4 + 2 = 30 × 3 – 4 + 2 = 90 – 4 + 2 = 88.

Q.19 · Answer (C) Leela
Dilip sits between Priya and Payal and Priti between Mukesh and Leela. Facing the centre, a person's immediate right is the next seat anticlockwise, and Payal is on Mukesh's right, so anticlockwise the order is Mukesh, Payal, Dilip, Priya, Leela, Priti. Leela comes next after Priya, on her immediate right.

Q.20 · Answer (B) 1
'Sky' (6) is common to the first two, 'dark' (7) to the last two and 'is' (4) to the first and third, so in '147' the remaining code, 1, stands for 'star'.

Q.21 · Answer (C) VSO
The letters move +2, +4 and +6: C → E, A → E, M → S and O → Q, A → E, T → Z. So T → V, O → S, I → O: VSO.

Q.23 · Answer (C) *$&5
Letter by letter, ORDER gives O = $, R = * and D = 5, and MATTER gives A = &. So ROAD = * $ & 5.

Q.25 · Answer (B) 86
The differences are +11, –7, +5, –3: the prime numbers in falling order, with alternating signs. The next is +2: 84 + 2 = 86.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (D) Vinay Mohan Kwatra
Vinay Mohan Kwatra, then India's ambassador to Nepal, was named the next Foreign Secretary in April 2022 and took charge on 1 May 2022, succeeding Harsh Vardhan Shringla.

Q.2 · Answer (B) Bihar
SSC's key gives Bihar. No census was taken in 2021 (it was postponed), so the question rests on Census 2011, in which Bihar had the lowest literacy rate of any state, 61.8%; Gujarat, Assam and Odisha were all above 72%.

Q.3 · Answer (A) Rajasthan
Gangaur, in honour of the goddess Gauri (Parvati), is one of Rajasthan's main festivals, celebrated chiefly by women in the month of Chaitra.

Q.4 · Answer (A) Creep
Creep, the very slow downslope movement of soil, is a slow mass movement, as is solifluction. Earthflows, mudflows and landslides are rapid movements.

Q.5 · Answer (D) Bombay (now Mumbai)
Atmaram Pandurang founded the Prarthana Samaj in Bombay, with M. G. Ranade and R. G. Bhandarkar among its leaders. The year usually given is 1867, not the 1863 in the question.

Q.6 · Answer (D) 29 August
India's National Sports Day, 29 August, marks the birthday of the hockey player Major Dhyan Chand.

Q.7 · Answer (B) Rudradaman
Rudradaman I, the Shaka (Western Kshatrapa) ruler of about 130-150 AD, is known from his Junagadh rock inscription. Ashoka and Bindusara were Mauryas and Menander an Indo-Greek king.

Q.8 · Answer (B) Principle of Cabinet Government and the relations between the executive and the legislature
Parliamentary (cabinet) government, with the executive answerable to the legislature, came from Britain. Fundamental Rights came from the US Constitution, the Directive Principles from Ireland's, and a federation with a strong centre and governors appointed by the centre from Canada's.

Q.9 · Answer (C) Rajasthan
In Census 2011 the lowest literacy rates among the states were Bihar's (61.8%), Arunachal Pradesh's (65.4%) and Rajasthan's (66.1%). Madhya Pradesh had 69.3% and Sikkim 81.4%.

Q.10 · Answer (C) Dengue
Dengue is spread by the Aedes mosquito, which breeds in stagnant water. Malaria is spread by the Anopheles mosquito, elephantiasis by Culex mosquitoes, and diarrhoea mostly through contaminated food and water.

Q.11 · Answer (C) Tropical evergreen rain forests
Tropical evergreen rain forests grow where the annual rainfall is over 200 cm. Temperate mixed forests, the taiga and the tundra get far less.

Q.12 · Answer (A) Rectangular
The Great Bath of Mohenjo-daro is a rectangular tank about 12 m long, 7 m wide and 2.4 m deep, with steps at each end.

Q.13 · Answer (C) Waiting for a Visa
'Waiting for a Visa', written in 1935-36, is B. R. Ambedkar's short autobiographical account of the untouchability he faced. 'Courage and Conviction' is General V. K. Singh's autobiography.

Q.14 · Answer (C) Odissi
Guru Kelucharan Mohapatra was a leading Odissi dancer and teacher, who did much to revive the form.

Q.15 · Answer (A) Swami Dayananda Saraswati
Swami Dayananda Saraswati founded the Arya Samaj in Bombay in 1875. Raja Ram Mohan Roy founded the Brahmo Samaj, and M. G. Ranade was a leader of the Prarthana Samaj.

Q.16 · Answer (B) Fiscal
FRBM stands for Fiscal Responsibility and Budget Management; the Act set targets for cutting the government's fiscal and revenue deficits.

Q.17 · Answer (C) Coulomb's Law
Coulomb's law gives the force between two point charges: it is proportional to the product of the charges and inversely proportional to the square of the distance between them.

Q.18 · Answer (B) Earthworm
Annelids are segmented worms, such as the earthworm and the leech. The honey bee is an arthropod, the squid a mollusc and the kangaroo a chordate (a mammal).

Q.19 · Answer (C) Rajasthan
Udaan is run in Rajasthan by the development consultancy IPE Global with the state government: it helps girls in classes 9 and 10 stay in school and get the government pre-matric scholarships they are eligible for, and also works against child marriage and teenage pregnancy.

Q.20 · Answer (A) 10 to 19 years
The World Health Organisation defines adolescents as people aged 10 to 19 years.

Q.21 · Answer (D) santoor
Pandit Shivkumar Sharma made the santoor, a hammered dulcimer from Jammu and Kashmir, a concert instrument of Hindustani classical music.

Q.22 · Answer (D) Attorney-General
Under Article 76 the Attorney-General for India is the country's highest law officer, who advises the Government of India on legal matters.

Q.23 · Answer (B) Razia Sultan
Minhaj-i Siraj, author of the 'Tabaqat-i Nasiri', chronicled the Delhi Sultanate of his time, including the reign of Razia Sultan (1236-1240). Babur wrote his own memoirs, Abul Fazl chronicled Akbar's reign, and Ghiyasuddin Tughluq ruled (1320-1325) long after Minhaj's time.

Q.24 · Answer (A) Kuchipudi
Aparna Satheesan, a Kuchipudi and Bharatanatyam dancer, was chosen for the National Nritya Shiromani Award 2022 for her contribution to Kuchipudi; it was announced in December 2021 for presentation at the 13th Cuttack Mahotsav in Odisha in January 2022.

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